

Mahesh M. Dhole

Department of Economics, Southern Illinois University, Carbondale, IL 62901
mahesh.dhole@siu.edu • +1 (618) 434 5124 • maheshdhole11.github.io

Curriculum Vitae — August 2026

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Southern Illinois University, Carbondale	2027–Expected
M.A. in Economics, Madurai Kamaraj University, Tamil Nadu, India	2017
B.E. in Civil Engineering, K.D.K. College of Engineering, Nagpur, India	2009

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Automation and Technological Change, Development Economics, Monetary Theory

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Does a High Minimum Wage Insulate or Expose Workers to the Effects of Technological Change? Evidence from U.S. States” [Draft]

This paper examines whether state minimum wage increases change how technological change affects employment and wages in the United States. Using occupation-level automation exposure measures from Webb (2020) and exploiting cross-state variation in minimum wages from 1980 to 2010, we find that higher minimum wages magnify both the employment and wage losses associated with software exposure: software-exposed occupations fared worse in states where minimum wages increased the most. The pattern differs for industrial robots. We find no comparable employment effect, but wages decline more in robot-exposed occupations where minimum wages rose more, with a wage interaction about twice the magnitude of the software estimate. Taken together, the results indicate that minimum wages do not interact uniformly with automation: wage floors amplify broad employment and wage adjustment under software exposure but mainly wage adjustment under robots. Minimum wage policy alone therefore appears insufficient to shield workers from technological change, and its labor-market effects depend on the form of automation to which workers are exposed.

WORKING PAPERS

“Taxing Automation’s Bite: State Corporate Taxes and the Labor Market Consequences of Robot and Software Exposure”

“Unequal Machines: Automation Inequality by Race and Gender in the United States”

WORK IN PROGRESS

“The Composition of State Taxation and Business Dynamism: Evidence from U.S. Firm Entry and Job Flows, 1978–2022” (with Yaren Gocer and Syeda Jahirin)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Southern Illinois University Carbondale

History and Philosophy of the World’s Economic Systems (ECON 302i, online) Summers 2025, 2026

Teaching Assistant, Southern Illinois University Carbondale

Microeconomics II (Graduate) Spring 2026

Mathematical Economics Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Econometrics I (Graduate) Spring 2025

Macroeconomics II (Graduate)	Spring 2024
Introduction to Macroeconomics	Fall 2023
Intermediate Macroeconomics	Spring 2023
Data Science II	Fall 2022

Research Assistant for Prof. Aparajita Dasgupta, Ashoka University, India Mar–May 2022

WORKING PAPER ABSTRACTS

“Taxing Automation’s Bite: State Corporate Taxes and the Labor Market Consequences of Robot and Software Exposure”

This paper examines whether state corporate tax regimes moderate the labor market consequences of automation exposure. Using the occupation-level exposure measures developed by Webb (2020) for robots and software and interacting them with cross-state variation in state corporate taxes, our estimates show a modest displacement effect: higher state corporate tax burdens are associated with larger employment losses in occupations exposed to automation from 1980–2010. The tax interaction is statistically significant but economically modest: a one percentage point increase in the corporate tax rate is associated with an additional employment-share decline of about 0.02 points for each percentile increase in automation exposure for occupations more exposed to robots and software. The robot–wage interaction is small and positive, consistent with a composition channel in which low-earning workers exit high-tax, robot-exposed occupations, raising average wages among remaining workers rather than implying broad wage gains for all workers.

“Unequal Machines: Automation Inequality by Race and Gender in the United States”

This paper examines whether robot and software automation exposure generates heterogeneous employment and wage effects by race and gender in the United States. Using the occupation-level automation exposure measures developed by Webb (2020) and IPUMS USA microdata, we estimate employment and wage outcomes separately for African American, White, female, and male workers. For software, we find no employment effects for any group but symmetric wage losses across race and gender. Industrial robots, by contrast, displace African American workers from employment while White workers experience no employment loss, and they generate a simultaneous contraction of female employment and expansion of male employment, with female workers facing approximately double the robot-induced wage loss of male workers. The type of automation—not automation per se—determines which dimension of labor market inequality is amplified.

WORK IN PROGRESS ABSTRACT

“The Composition of State Taxation and Business Dynamism: Evidence from U.S. Firm Entry and Job Flows, 1978–2022” (with Yaren Gocer and Syeda Jahirin)

Asks whether the composition of state taxation—capital versus labor—affects firm entry and job creation, linking a 45-year state tax panel to the Census Bureau’s Business Dynamics Statistics across state, sector, and county designs with wild-cluster bootstrap.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Midwest Economic Association (MEA) 83rd Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	2026
Southern Economic Association (SEA) 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL	2025
Illinois Economic Association (IEA) 54th Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	2025
Fall Brown Bag Seminar, SIU Carbondale, Carbondale, IL	2025

Data-Intensive Research Conference, Minneapolis, MN	2025
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FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

Dissertation Research Assistantship Award, Southern Illinois University Carbondale	2026–2027
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Project Manager , NcRomer Corporation, India	2013–2021
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Project Officer , Adani Power Maharashtra Ltd., India	2011–2012
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CERTIFICATIONS

FRED Data Practitioner: Micro Credentials & Badging	2024
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Essential Tools in Optimization	2020
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Optimization & Statistical Models & Tools (OSMT-2020)	2020
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International Conference on Recent Trends in Mathematics & its Applications to Graph, Networks & Petri Nets (ICRTMA-GPN-2020)	2020
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UNIVERSITY SERVICE

President, Economics Student Association (ESA), SIUC	2024–2026
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Member, Economics Student Association (ESA), SIUC	2023–2024
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SKILLS

Software: Stata, R, Python, E-Views

Applications: $\text{\LaTeX}$, Zotero, Microsoft Office Suite, Advanced Excel

Languages: Marathi (native), Hindi and English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Kevin Sylwester (Dissertation Committee Chair)

School of Analytics, Finance and Economics, Southern Illinois University
ksylwest@siu.edu • +1 (618) 453-1421

Alison Watts (Dissertation Committee Member)

School of Analytics, Finance and Economics, Southern Illinois University
wattsa@siu.edu • +1 (618) 453-5073

Scott Gilbert (Dissertation Committee Member)

School of Analytics, Finance and Economics, Southern Illinois University
gilberts@siu.edu • +1 (618) 453-5095

Zsolt Becsi (Dissertation Committee Member)

School of Analytics, Finance and Economics, Southern Illinois University
becsi@siu.edu • +1 (618) 453-5067